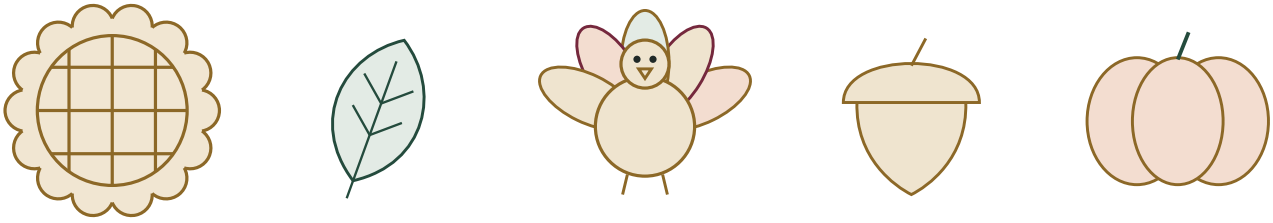
CyberDadKit

THE GATHERING COLLECTION

Thanksgiving
Host Dinner Planner

Plan the meal, the guests and the leftovers

Undated, write-in pages for one gathering:
countdown, cooking plan, menu, recipes, shopping,
guests, seating, serving and leftovers.



Undated: any year

Write-in grids and checklists

Food-safety facts from USDA FSIS

A4 / restrained harvest color
18 pages including a host note

Digital PDF. No physical item. No subscription.

INSIDE

Countdown checklist, menu planner, 4 recipe cards, shopping list, make-ahead list, hour-by-hour cooking plan, oven and appliance schedule, guest list and RSVPs, potluck sign-up, seating chart, table setting and decor, drinks and serving dishes, leftovers plan, 10 leftover labels, thank-yous and notes.

A note for the host

How to use it

Work front to back: weeks-before pages (3-8), the cooking day (9-10), guests and the table (11-15), then after the meal (16-18). Every page is undated and write-in.

Printing

Print US Letter (8.5 x 11 in) or A4 (210 x 297 mm) to match your paper: portrait, single-sided, 100% / Actual size, not borderless. Content stays inside half-inch (12.7 mm) margins; if edges clip, use Fit to printable area. Low-ink editions are gray and black with no fills. Reprint any page you need more of.

Tablet edition

The tablet PDF adds a tappable index (page 2) and tappable section tabs on every page. Open it in a PDF app that supports handwriting and internal links, and write in the blank areas. Link behavior varies by app; every page also has a bookmark.

Food-safety facts

Facts labeled USDA FSIS or FoodSafety.gov restate those agencies' published consumer guidance, checked November 2026. See fsis.usda.gov and foodsafety.gov for current guidance.

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Policy: https://getcyberdadkit.com/holiday/host-planner/refund/

Countdown checklist

Undated: count back from your meal day. Check off what applies and add your own tasks on the blank lines.

FOOD-SAFETY FACTS

Thawing in the refrigerator (40 °F or below): allow approximately 24 hours for every 4 to 5 pounds of turkey. A thawed turkey can remain in the refrigerator for 1 to 2 days. (USDA FSIS)

3 WEEKS OUT

- [ ] Pick the meal time and guest list
- [ ] Choose: host-cooked, potluck or a mix
- [ ] Sketch the menu (page 4)
- [ ] Count chairs, plates and glasses
- [ ] Order a turkey, if using one
- [ ] _____

2 WEEKS OUT

- [ ] Invite guests; start RSVPs (page 11)
- [ ] Share the potluck list (page 12)
- [ ] Gather recipes (pages 5-6)
- [ ] Buy drinks and pantry items
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

1 WEEK OUT

- [ ] Confirm RSVPs and dietary notes
- [ ] Finish the shopping list (page 7)
- [ ] Plan seating (page 13)
- [ ] Clear fridge and freezer space
- [ ] Frozen turkey: plan the thaw (above)
- [ ] _____

2-3 DAYS BEFORE

- [ ] Buy fresh produce, dairy and bread
- [ ] Start make-ahead items (page 8)
- [ ] Wash serving dishes and linens
- [ ] Label serving dishes (page 15)
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

THE DAY BEFORE

- [ ] Set the table (page 14)
- [ ] Prep vegetables, sauces and pies
- [ ] Chill drinks; clear the counters
- [ ] Fill in pages 9-10 for the day
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

THE DAY ITSELF

- [ ] Follow the hour-by-hour plan
- [ ] Check the turkey with a thermometer
- [ ] Set out drinks and starters
- [ ] Pack and label leftovers (pages 16-17)
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____